WHO ARE MY CLIENTS

PROMOTIONAL CHAPTERS

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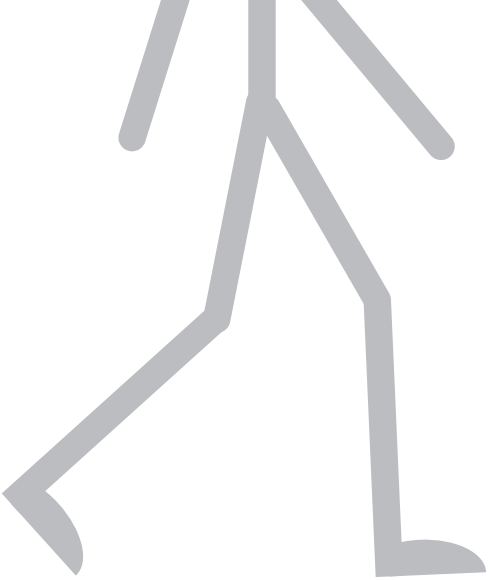


INTRODUCTION

Let me set the stage and put things in context right from the beginning with a short story, maybe something from your childhood as it was from mine? It's a sunny afternoon, early July, back in the middle years of your childhood when the Internet sounds like R2D2 from *Star Wars* due to dial-up modems, pop comes in glass bottles from the Pop Shop and all your toys don't have tiny attachable parts with choking hazard signs. These are the good old days. The days when all you want to do was go out exploring, race through the neighbourhood with your friends or build forts in the forest. Instead, today, you're sitting here outside your house, baking in the afternoon sun as your mom forces you to help out with the annual garage sale.

It's not all bad though, you tell yourself. You might have been really sad last night at the thought of parting with some old toys you haven't looked at for the last five years, but at least you might get some money from it. In fact, you've been daydreaming about it all morning: all that cash from instantly selling your stuff, just stuffing your Kraft peanut butter jar – your homemade piggy bank. With it, you could buy that new BMX bike that looks like a gas-powered motocross with real shocks, add windows to your tree fort or treat yourself to larger weekly stashes of Swedish Berries and chips all summer. Oh! The endless possibilities. But there's only one problem.

Nobody's taking your stuff. Sure, your mom's old blue glass plates and grandma's spoon collection aren't really flying off the shelf either, but your parents seem to be getting a heck of a lot more traffic than you. Dad is selling old tools. A wave of local students are rummaging through mom's old kitchen equipment. Your toys, the ones you deemed worthy of giving up, have barely warranted a glance.

So what's your problem? Well, in hindsight like with most things, it's fairly easy to spot. You live in a college neighbourhood with plenty of single adults and few children. It's a hot summer day and the few kids from the neighbourhood are out playing (like you wanted to do), not scanning garages on the off chance someone might be selling a limited edition of a Tintin comic or a super-powered He-Man action figure with three poses. Last problem, you're selling things that were not good enough for you to keep. If it was not good enough for you to keep, it is probably not good enough for others to buy. Plus you naively thought, I have setup my garage sale table, I have things to sell and therefore, people will show up at my sale to buy them. And on top of that, you thought "Just to make sure, I'll sell it cheap that way price will not be a problem."

The truth of the matter is, a lot of entrepreneurs in 2017 spend just as little time today really thinking about their clients as we did as kids for garage sales. Business owners and operators all across the world aren't connecting with their clients and as such, are throwing away the opportunity to unlock their potential. They do this because they fail to recognize one simple truth: businesses solve people's problems.

YOU MUST RECOGNIZE ONE SIMPLE TRUTH: BUSINESSES SOLVE PEOPLE'S PROBLEMS.

The purpose of any enterprise is to fill some void, to make people's lives better and easier, to meet some need the market wants, what the market is looking for.

We actually learn this from a very young age. When we saw thirsty strangers crossing our neighbourhood on a hot summer's day, the more industrious of us erected lemonade stands and charged fifty cents a glass for that cool, satisfying beverage. When the school stopped selling pop from its premises, we snuck some in and made a small fortune profiteering from our peers' sugar craving.

A business can only survive if it serves some purpose in the community. A man with no car will not buy tires. A woman without a cell-phone will not download a cool, new app. A family without pets will not purchase dog-food. You can create the finest products ever imagined, but if no one has the problem you are trying to solve, they will not sell. A business without clients cannot keep its doors open.

In a world increasingly driven by data points and complex algorithms, it can be difficult to see one's client as an individual, even as a human being. In the towers of corporate giants with millions of customers, we might all look like nothing more than numbers, but not only is this the wrong approach or attitude, it's false.

A casual observer might see us as people with no great difference from one to the next, yet that doesn't explain why one person walks in for a morning coffee at Starbucks and another chooses to sit in the drive-through at Tim Hortons. Our individuality guides our behaviour. But we are often clueless about where this comes from and how it affects us. We might live in Canada, a country famously known for its landscapes and distinct four seasons, but when the winter skies pour piles of snow, some families might buy a seasonal ski pass whereas others are already planning their trips to warmer climates in the Caribbean.

Knowing one's client is so much more than market research that can be done in one's pyjamas with a computer, Google spitting facts and printing reports allowing us to be finished by break-time. It requires connecting with people on a deeper level and doing the required mental gymnastics to get there. Entrepreneurs who consider themselves remarkably knowledgeable about their clients might be able to recite their age, salary, schedules, areas where they live and other useful data. Yet, ask them a more thought-provoking question like "Why did the client decide to look for your store in the first place?" or "What are their core motivations, what do they want, need and desire?" And suddenly more than seventy percent of them will go blank. They then revert back to the mounds of statistics and the easily quantifiable data.

Knowing one's client cannot end at simply determining if they have the capacity to buy from you – the cash in their account or the available credit on the credit card. You need to know, to understand, where the buying decision originated. You need to determine their problems, more importantly the best problem that you can solve for your client. You need to know who is most likely to want this offering. And then you must ask what is the best message to let them know how you can help them and why it is important to them.

YOU NEED TO KNOW AND UNDERSTAND WHERE THE BUYING DECISION ORIGINATED.

As much as we may not like it, the world is changing. It is now an enormous expansion of markets due to globalization and accessibility of information. Local, independent entrepreneurs have never had so much competition.

Clients are the foundation of your business. Without them, your business could not exist. Yet many entrepreneurs seem to know almost nothing about them. Instead, many entrepreneurs often adopt Kevin Costner's Field of Dreams attitude of *Build it and they will come*. They think that their product has automatic value, that their business deserves customers just by existing.

Then some think, "I'll sell it cheaper than the others, I'll get more business with more sales." But this is only true if you are selling commodities. Commodities only sell if they are as good as the others available. They only sell as long as you have the cheapest price. But once someone has something comparable that is cheaper, poof! Your clients disappear and often, it is just a matter of time before the arrival of a cheaper comparable product occurs. Do you want to build a business based on commodities? Some might, but most don't.

It can be possible to have success from just studying the observable, measurable, quantifiable external factors of your client's behaviour alone, much in the same way you don't always need to attend class to pass the final exam. If it's multiple choice, you can guess and hope you're lucky. If you're smart, you can deduct and guess your way through it and use a little common sense. Either way, you will probably not be getting honours, and perhaps most importantly, you won't be getting peace of mind. The student who studied for thirty-six hours straight before the exam might end up doing just as well, but at least she knew going in that she had done everything possible to get the best mark possible, and in the end, that's all life can really ask of us.

This book isn't a recipe for guaranteed success but it will make success much more likely if you work at

understanding your client. Taking the time to learn how to acquire, analyze and use emotional information alongside rational data will not only provide a more stable, long-term strategy for your business, but it's also your best weapon against the tightening squeeze of your competitors.

No matter how much data is collected and sorted by entrepreneurs, seventy percent of the buying process takes place somewhere less concrete and where numbers will not offer much insight: the emotional side of the brain.

Understanding your clients helps build better teams by hiring people who respond to your clientele. It helps close sales faster by connecting with the client on a deeper level. It helps connect how your services solve your client's problems and resolve their motivations. It also helps you spend less money on ineffectual advertising by connecting with potential clients that are actually interested in your services, and not simply all those who happen to fall into your market segment. Ultimately, the better you understand your clients, the better you can respond to their needs, reduce their frustrations and pain points, and develop superior products, services and business practices that will bring in more revenue and greater success.

Yet in my consultations with entrepreneurs when topics were brought up directly linked to clients, it was like the same words of hindsight were said over and over again. "How'd I not think of this?" "Why did I just assume that?" "Boy, that's a lot of things to think about!" All good reflections, no doubt, but if you've waited until after you've lost tens of thousands of dollars on the wrong investment to question yourself, it's already too late or just

very expensive. Success comes from knowing your client *before* you begin your business venture, rather than hope to stumble upon it afterwards.

It might seem straightforward, basic, or very obvious to some of you but unfortunately it happens all the time. This book is not going to be like many of the business books you might have seen out there. If you truly want to start connecting with your client, there's no step-by-step guide that will tell you exactly how to do that, and there are no one-stop-shops that will give you all the information you will need.

What this book will do is show you how to change your mindset, to alter your thinking and help solve client problems yourself. Don't think of this as a recipe book, but as a cooking class. It will change how you think and develop your skill set.

This book will give you the tools you can use to address any business venture, over and over again. You will need to work to make sure you are successful. You will have to do the things that may seem unnatural at first, but will become familiar over time.

The goal is to make you a better entrepreneur and allow you to tackle every part of your business with purpose, in order to connect with as many clients as possible and truly solve their problems. In addition, this book can also support you in your journey to become a better problem solver, a better communicator, and potentially a better person.

It will help you build a solid foundation with a focussed clientele and a winning strategy to both reach and serve them. If you're already experiencing success and are

looking to expand, this book will assist you to grow your client base in the best possible way and expand your business in a manner that makes sense for your customers. Finally, if your business just isn't giving the kind of rewards you want, this book will help focus operations around the right clients to build long-term stable success.

Every business is different. This mindset can be used no matter what stage your business is in (idea, start-up, stabilisation, growth, maturity, etc.). The way you apply it, is up to you. Not only should you understand and build something for your clients, but you should take it a step further. You must, as a business owner, as an entrepreneur or as someone involved in the business, become the expert on your client. You should aim to know your clients as well as they know themselves. Through this book, the objective is to help entrepreneurs fundamentally change how they approach their business.

It is time to create a new movement, a new culture; a movement that focuses on a key expertise, one of experts on their clients. My goal is that you will join me in this movement. By the end of the book, the hope is that you will see what I see and believe what I believe – that entrepreneurs need to be experts on their clients. This means having intimate knowledge and understanding of your clients; understanding how they think, act and react. Time to show you the reason to join the client expertise movement.

IT IS TIME TO CREATE A NEW MOVEMENT, A NEW CULTURE: A MOVEMENT THAT FOCUSES ON A KEY EXPERTISE, ONE OF EXPERTS ON THEIR CLIENTS.

INTERNAL FACTORS BRING US TO THE DECISION TO BUY AND EXTERNAL FACTORS DETERMINE IF WE CAN BUY.

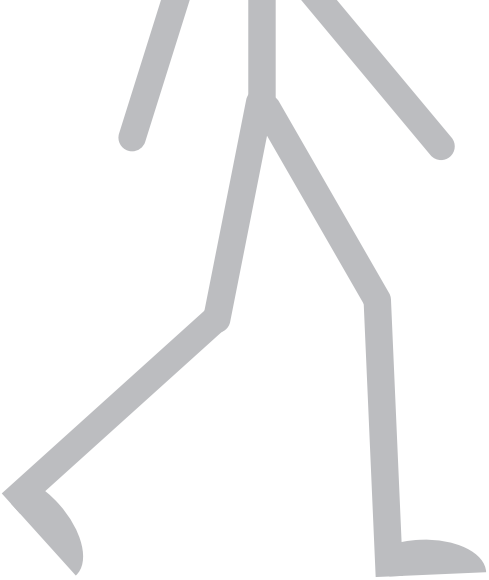
This book will illustrate how hundreds of people were successfully helped, share some personal entrepreneurial stories and explain the development of the approach. You will discover the difference between the Internal Factors that bring us to the decision to buy and the External Factors that determine if we can buy. You will determine how to collect, test and analyze internal and external information to better understand your clients.

Lastly, you will learn how to put those pieces of information together and apply them in building a better business. You will see how to use the information to establish your primary clientele, to grow to secondary segments or once you have established and stabilised your company, explore tertiary groups. You will understand how to apply this information to your business and how to use internal and external knowledge to create ideal marketing campaigns, effective messaging, better employment strategies, more refined products or services and much more.

This book was written because as a business coach, surprisingly, one of the hardest questions to answer for the entrepreneurs I coach, is:

"Who are your clients?"

1



THE ORIGIN OF THE BOOK

"I find that the harder I work, the more luck I seem to have."

– Thomas Jefferson

01 PROPOSING A RETURN TO BASICS

As businesspeople, our job is not simply to analyze and reflect over the dilemmas of the day like journalists, but to actually fix them. After all, as entrepreneurs, this is even more important as our livelihood depends on it.

There is a misconception that businesses are encouraged to think of their customers as data points in their sales funnel instead of people, and entrepreneurs therefore often have no real picture of the client they wish to serve. The business culture of today reinforces a mindset that, in many ways creates and continues to foster this problem.

"Knowing your client" is the type of vague pronouncement you might read in a typical self-help book and learn from a generic seminar. But let's explore it a little more.

For one, it does not mean simply knowing their statistics, their data. This information is useful but it is far from the whole story. Income and demographics can tell a lot about a person, but it fails to demonstrate motivations, purpose or desire; to understand who that person truly is.

Knowing one's client is not just measurable or quantifiable. It doesn't just mean listing their revenues, marital status, homeownership, trends or listing other data points. Businesses built on those elements will last as long as the trend itself as opinions, tastes and jobs shift over time.

We need to go further beyond the numbers and the data. We need to start to find out why our clients are looking for a solution, discover what is motivating them and uncover what their needs are. It is only at that point that we can really understand what it means to "know your client".

Knowing your client means asking all the questions that can't be gathered by a computer. It means starting to understand the unseen side of people; understanding their psyche. It doesn't mean you have to become the next Sigmund Freud, Carl Jung or Carl Rogers, all great minds of the psychology world. But rather take a step back and remember that each one of your clients, although they can be grouped and categorised rationally, they are in fact emotional, feeling beings – each and every one of them. Not just a simple data set.

As entrepreneurs, we must be willing to change our perception of our clients. It isn't just about succeeding with our business, but building a better, more stable, more sustainable company that will weather the ups and downs of a business. We need to be experts on our clients, both on the emotional and the rational factors.

This book will teach you how to do these things on your own, so that you can repeat this process many times and truly understand why you are doing it. It will show you the path, but you will have to work in order to successfully tread it.

This is not a one-size-fits-all solution. Every business is unique with its own realities and challenges. Every entrepreneur behind them is even more so. And every client, although we can see patterns and similarities, are also quite unique.

It is important to pause and clear things up on two particular subjects that come up in this book. First, solving a problem is what is used to describe what we, as entrepreneurs, ultimately do. To make sure we are using the terms the same way, a problem for me is something that needs to be resolved. It does not have to be negative. It could be around efficiencies, time savings, ease of use as well as stopping something that is negative to us. A problem in the context of this book, is to go from one point to another, from one state to another, from here to there, now matter how big or small, how important, how mundane or how impactful. A problem gives a purpose to the business; the thing the business will solve for its clients.

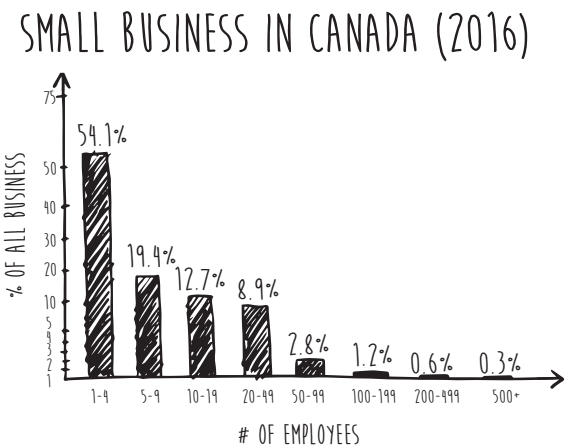
The second is addressing target market or market segment. Many of you might have encountered the concept of your target market and there are books, templates and videos out there on the subject matter. And it is important. But target markets or market segments are groupings of individuals who have similar characteristics and sometimes, similar personalities. Where I want you to focus is to develop and look at each person, it is understanding the ideal person who will be willing to buy your product without compromise – someone who will become the champion of your brand. You need to make

sure that you have found and identified the right client, to understand them, their motivations and their desires.

You first need to identify the individual, then identify the group they are part of. Too many entrepreneurs start and stop at the group and so they never truly understand each person. This is the challenge addressed in this book. This is how you are going to connect with your client and build a successful business.

It is not the first time someone states that each of your clients are unique; nor the first reminder that your clients are all human beings who have their own story, experiences and perceptions. But, many of the key questions are rarely asked by small businesses today.

As micro-enterprise (1 to 4 employees) represents 54.1% of employers in 2016, and small business (less than 100 employees according to Statistics Canada and less than 20 employees according to the US Small Business & Entrepreneurship Council) make up 43.8%[1] with big business only representing 2.1%, I feel the need to remind micro enterprise and small business owners to stop, and get to know their clients.



To help illustrate the approach, let's frame the information within a metaphor – imagine we're building a house.

Like entrepreneurs who focus on numbers and statistics, when people are asked to picture a house they will most often think of four walls and a roof. Even as kids, this is what we draw. Yet mindsets like these can often misguide a person and miss the big picture. Yes, a house is *technically* four walls and a roof, but it also requires a more concrete base. It needs something to hold these walls and roof up. There are internal components that we do not see that make up the basic structure of the house.

Tossing building materials together won't make a house; good planning and building will. You can't decide you want windows and then leave no wall space to insert them. You can't buy chandeliers if your ceiling is too weak to support them. It's an exaggeration, but you get the point as it pertains to building a house.

Unfortunately, this type of thinking is all too common in the world of small business. Many businesses have great ideas for products or services, but they do not know who might want to buy from them. This is a scary thought as many entrepreneurs livelihoods and well-being depend on their business, and yet it was often thrown together. These businesspeople assume they will be successful but do not make the plans necessary to be so.

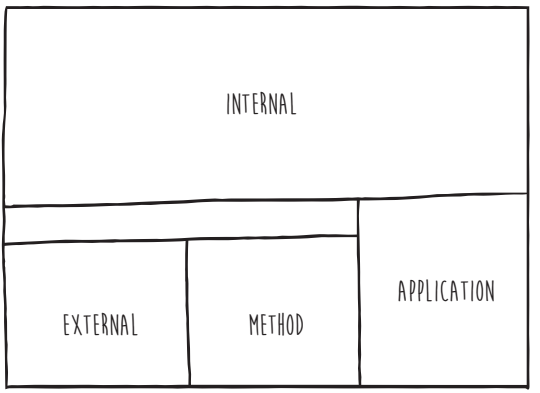
You need to understand who is around to help, what is possible, who is going to purchase it, what is possible now, what needs to be done for tomorrow, etc.

A business, no matter what it does or where it is in the world, is not a business if it does not have clients. This is a simple and straightforward thought. And yet, time and time again, clients are an after-thought. This has to change if we want more businesses to succeed and grow. We need to put the client first in our business.

A BUSINESS, NO MATTER WHAT IT DOES OR WHERE IT IS IN THE WORLD, IS NOT A BUSINESS IF IT DOES NOT HAVE CLIENTS.

To start to build the metaphor, we need to first identify, plan and lay a strong foundation. This is what you entire business is built on and ensures success at all other levels. The foundation of a business is its clients. The first floor allows us to focus on the important, it's the main floor. This is where you find 2 key concepts the foundation of this book. Let's go inside and explore what I call Internal Factors and External Factors. These are the specific terms I will use throughout.

MAIN FLOOR



To the top of the image of the main floor, we have the Internal Factors room. It is the main room of the house and it takes a whole side. It is the emotional, qualitative information of your clients. In the following chapters, we'll discuss the impact, strategies on how to collect and to use *internal* information, as well as approaches to test its usefulness. Finally, we'll explore how far you should go in collecting this information, and how much you should rely on it.

To the bottom left of the image is something probably more familiar to you, the External Factors room. This smaller room will be the rational, quantifiable data: the *external* information that can be rationalized and studied, the easiest information to find and the most readily at our disposal. Here we will look at what allows your client to follow through with their decision to buy. We will identify how to find the right information to support your business, how to analyze it correctly, and use it to complement your internal information.

Next to the External Factors room is the Method room that explores how to build a business, which approach is right for your client and also right for you.

At the end of this hallway to the right is the Applications room where we put these pieces of information together to form a workable plan. We will recognize what kind of patterns are appearing. We will determine what kind of clients you want to work with, and if they are the clients who are most willing to use and pay for the solutions you have developed. We will also explore how to build the right business to deliver all of this.

So, that's the framework and the approach. Let's begin the journey to getting to know your clients better.

"All progress takes place outside
the comfort zone."
– Michael John Bobak

02 DESCRIBING TWO REAL EXAMPLES

In all of our lives there's bound to be a few moments that, for whatever reason, we know we will remember forever. Every image, every word and every detail will be burned into our memory, and we will never forget it. I have had a couple moments like that too, and a couple of those led me to the knowledge shared with you today.

During the start-up phase of my official business-coaching firm and working with Invest Ottawa (I.O.), I was meeting all sorts of entrepreneurs. They were from all industries ranging from product sales to service delivery. These entrepreuneurs were at various stages from the idea to preparation for retirement. And they had different financial challenges from the "no-money start-up" to the "I poured my life savings and retirement money into the business".

I was taking a very traditional hands-on approach in giving extremely specific step-by-step advice to my clients. Although each individual allowed me to learn and grow, two people from that time still stick out in my mind, and really helped shape the approach and the concepts shared in this book: the personal trainer and the PhD in Education.

EXAMPLE: OMAR, THE PERSONAL TRAINER

The personal trainer, lets call him Omar, has been in the industry for over 15 years and has built a good base of recurring clients, some even for many years as well as a good list of punctual clients He has many types of certifications. All in all, he appears to be someone who should be doing well and be comfortable in his business, especially with the shift in society towards healthy living and fitness.

Yet Omar was having a harder and harder time to fill his schedule and after trying different types of promotions, ads and approaches, he decided to get an outside point of view and booked an appointment at I.O. He showed up ready to share, ready to listen and eager to learn. But what struck me the most during our consultation, is that Omar talked about his business with a focus on him, on how he likes his services.

Omar was sharing years of experience and what he has discovered of his business, the skills, the expertise, the costs, the market and how his services has developed over time. But during this conversation, rarely did he talk about his clients, other than to confirm that he recorded information on them on things like where they worked, what they wore, how they travelled and to where, what type of car they drove and more. But when I asked Omar

about what had made them decide to come to see him, to explore physical fitness, to consider a personal trainer, to book his services, he went right back to the statistics and the trends he has noticed.

Although he knew a lot of information about his clients, Omar really did not "know" his clients. I asked him what had motivated his clients to come to see him. I asked him what drove his clients to seek his services. I asked what were his clients true desires: being active – sure, a healthy body – ok, but what were those goals truly motivated by? Omar could not answer. He was speechless.

We spent the rest of the session working together, exploring their potential motivations, what had first driven them to seek his services, what were the reasons that they might be coming back to see him. We both saw that he needed to understand more about why his clients sought his services.

Omar already knew most of the information needed as his work allowed him to work intimately with each client and here was his first insights: most of his clients wanted to change their lifestyle, had tried so many of the common trends but had not been successful. Omar's clients were looking for someone who was willing to work with them over time, understand their realities, their needs and be able to develop/adjust a plan that worked with their current realities. They were looking for someone who would listen to their needs physically, but also in terms of time and commitment realities, and had the skill set and the knowledge to change and adapt with them.

He quickly saw and understood this new perspective and now had a plan to further explore and validate these findings. A couple of weeks later, I got an email from Omar indicating that he had not stopped since our meeting

and as he got better and better at understanding his client, at defining his client, he was already seeing the changes in his business. He had learned that it was not his certificates that were the most important to his success, but rather his potential to help by understanding and connecting with his client's motivations and adapting his services to their realities.

EXAMPLE: MARIA, HER AFTER SCHOOL PROGRAM

Maria's story is similar to Omar's and yet different. Maria is also an expert in her field with a long list of credentials: she has a bachelor degree in science, a teaching degree, a Master's in social work and a PhD in Education.

Maria did her thesis on learning habits and their techniques (without knowing the intimate details) and is an expert in her field as her final dissertation was published and she has been invited to speak on the matter at various conferences.

Her continued research and drive stemmed from the fact that her own kids have slight learning disabilities and she saw how hard it was to help her own kids, even with her expertise. She wanted to help other parents who are in similar situations and are facing similar challenges.

Maria knew that parents with children with learning disabilities, slight or severe, have an additional challenges and therefore, started an early childhood program to help kids develop good habits and give them techniques. To reach the parents, she was promoting to parent-teacher groups to have them set-up a program at their school.

But her program was not being received as she thought it would – Maria thought it would be a sure thing as it would help kids at all levels, even those who did not have

problems. What more could a school or parents want from a program for their children, she thought? Yet most parent groups did not want to spend their limited budget on her program nor were they interested in pitching it to their school.

After a year of work to develop and promote her program without much success, Maria booked a consultation and we had the opportunity to meet and discuss her business and challenges for 60 minutes. She was determined to make her business work. She wanted to understand why things were not going according to her plan, why her clients were not responding to her business as anticipated.

Maria quickly shared her background, short explanation of her business and quickly got to the challenge. She then continued to explain that the majority of parents who were paying for her program were the ones who wanted their kids to close the gap to a perfect score; the ones who wanted their kids to gain those elusive missing points. She was happy clients were paying for her program and yet was discouraged. Although she could help those children continue to develop better habits, they were already driven and for the most part, already had great study habits. She was dealing with the parents who had already decided that their kids, at the age of 6, were to become doctors, lawyers and engineers.

When I asked who was her target client, she told me school children. When I asked her to be more specific, she said school children in the Ottawa area from educated families, who's parents both had degrees and who were from medium to affluent salary range. What she was sharing with me allowed me to understand what her clients needed to be able to purchase from her but not why they had decided to seek out help in the first place.

But when I asked Maria to tell me more about these clients, much like Omar, she was unable to give me more information other than her clients were driven and very persistent. When I asked her to talk a little more as to their behaviours, their desires, she then added that they would generally book in groups of 10 sessions.

After a few more questions, it was clear that although she was an expert in her field or work, she really could only give me stats about the clients who were coming to see her and to use her services. When I asked about what motivated them to come see her in the first place, she got uncomfortable as she could not answer.

When I asked Maria what problem she was solving, what was the need that she was addressing, she confidently described her services and the expected results.

Once again, it was apparent that although Maria was an expert in her field, she was struggling as she was also not an expert on her client. It was clear to me that I was onto something.

"Before anything else, preparation is the key to success."

– Alexander Graham Bell

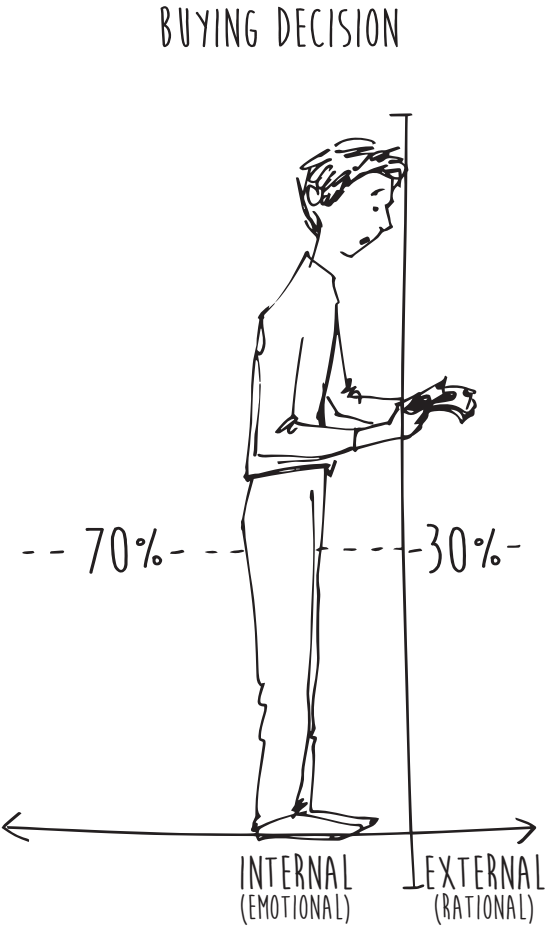
03 THE UNCONSCIOUS VERSUS THE TANGIBLE

I tell Omar & Maria's stories for another reason other than to motivate you to think of your client before you open or expand your business. It serves to show the difference between understanding and defining one's market (which these entrepreneurs did well) and defining one's client (which they could not do).

Simply put, the market is the group of individuals who all buy products similar to yours or who have the problem you are solving. It's a very generic bracket of people with similarities that bring them together, yet it doesn't explain what specific experience each particular individual is looking for. It doesn't explain why they would want to purchase your product, why they prefer this shade of

blue versus another, or why they set out to find your solution in the first place. Statistical market research is certainly useful, but it can only take your business so far.

Whereas the Internal Factors underlie *why* a person chooses they need to buy, the External Factors reveal *how* a person is able to buy something.



Internal Factors are the feelings, desires and motivations that can't be put into actual data or that can't be seen, measured or quantified. They can only be found by discovering through the human being. No client can be effectively defined without looking at these Internal Factors, and that is why pure market research focused on External Factors such as habits, salaries, brands, region, etc. will never be strong enough on its own.

INTERNAL FACTORS ARE THE FEELINGS AND MOTIVATIONS THAT CAN'T BE PUT INTO ACTUAL DATA, THAT CAN'T BE SEEN, MEASURED OR QUANTIFIED.

Every human is a member of the water market. We all need water to survive. That doesn't automatically mean everyone is going to buy water from a plastic, 500ml bottle even if it is a good price. Some don't want to contribute to the over-growth of landfills as there may not be recycling in the area, some might consider the depletion of the rainforest, the debris pollution of our seas, climate change or any other factors. If those feelings, if those worries, those things that cannot be seen or measured are top of mind, it will not matter that they are thirsty and the water bottle is cheap. They'll prefer to take a chance and hope to find a water fountain over the next hill and not contribute to the problems. This is the impact of an Internal Factor over an External Factor. This is the difference between *why* someone will consider something versus *what* they need to purchase.

Conventional market wisdom would say that if the utility a bottle filled with water brings is higher than its objective cost, they would buy it. They are thirsty and therefore the utility of the water will be relatively high. The water bottle is also reasonably cheap, and the pain they would

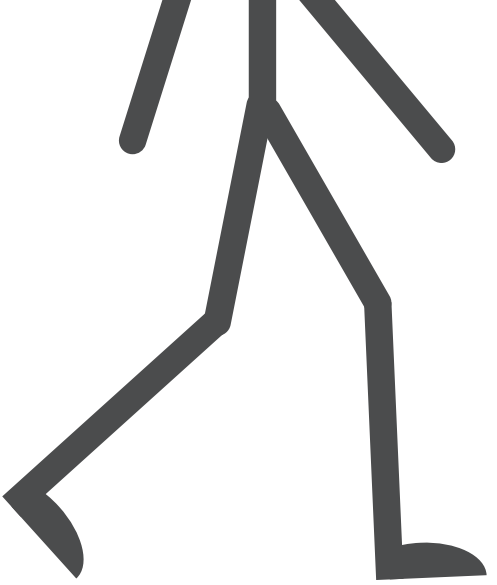
feel in spending money is much less than the pleasure they would gain in quenching my thirst. It's all perfectly rational, yet they still won't buy the darn bottle.

The reason that dehumanizing the client, and assuming they make all their decisions on a rational, localised scale is an inherently unsustainable way of doing business because it allows for huge investments and incredible speculation that aren't supported by need or desire. The water bottle vendor might have read the weather report and realized it would be a hot day, so she poured her assets into getting as many bottles as possible and trying to sell them quickly and in bulk. But the problem is, if she is trying to sell to individuals who did not believe in unsustainable sources of water, then she would be surprised by the results.

We all have probably heard of a business that has invested large sums of money on ads, high-end improvements, but that were totally unsuccessful. We probably heard a story of better products being set aside for something of lesser quality – there are so many examples. A great example of this was Sony's Betamax versus JVC's VHS in the 1980s and 1990s.

No matter the product or service, a client needs to have a) identified they needed to resolve something [motivation], b) establised their reason to purchase it [problem], c) decided they want to purchase it from you [connection] and d) confirmed they have the ability to buy it [capability].

WHO **ARE** MY CLIENTS



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Thank you for downloading and reading the promotional chapters. In order to better understand Internal and External Factors, how to complete their discovery and how to integrate this knowledge into your business, visit the website to order your copy of the book.

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